

Camera

According to our survey, more than 50 per cent of Indian users are dissatisfied with their smartphone's selfie shooter. And for good reason. Most smartphones' selfie cameras fall short in one domain or another, be it low-light photography, selfie portraits or absurd amounts of beautification. We'd love to have an under-display selfie camera, like the one Oppo recently unveiled, to completely eliminate the need for a notch or pop-up camera. However, for both front and rear shooters, we'd choose Pixel's glorious cameras that are absolute technological marvels with software optimisation at its best. We'd be ready to add another rear camera for a wide-angle lens which produces some unique shots.



Battery life and charging

A smartphone with stellar battery life, in our opinion, can easily breeze through one day of heavy usage and still have some juice at the end of the day. The battery size could be anywhere between 3500mAh to 5000mAh. A good battery life is one of the foremost features Indians scout for, when buying a smartphone. Contrary to popular belief, software optimisation can increase battery life way more than added mAh. The smartphone would also come with a Warp charger (present in the OnePlus 7 Pro) which is by far the fastest charger out there. Wireless charging would be a bonus!

Price point

Speaking of price, the perfect smartphone for Indian needs would cost anywhere between ₹10,000 to ₹20,000. In our smartphone survey, we found that over 45 per cent of Indians already own or wish to buy their next smartphone within this price range. Brands like Xiaomi, with their astounding POCO F1 and Redmi K20 Pro, have already proven that flagship specs and some elusive features can be included within a conservative price range. It is especially critical since India is a highly price-sensitive market.



User Interface

At the Digit test labs, we are ardent fans of the stock Android experience. Why shouldn't we be? It is simplistic and classy, has minimal bloatware and has exceedingly snappy animations. One UI is also proving to be a great skin that, in some ways, adds to the Android experience. For Indian needs, iOS experience would also be optimal since it is extremely user-friendly, has probably the smoothest transitions and animations and just looks fantastic, but we're aiming too high for the price range now.



AI and AR features

AI has mostly been limited to Voice Assistants in a large number of smartphone brands. However, utilising AI to its maximum potential can bring in an array of utilitarian features like AI scene detection in cameras, AI-driven performance mode, smart battery utilisation and more. When it comes to AR in smartphones, AR platforms like ARCore and ARKit can usher in a slew of AR-enabled apps and features that can transform the way we use smartphones today. The outstanding success of apps like Pokemon Go and Snapchat are testaments to the power of AR.

Budget-less outlandish wishlist

- Back panel changes colours according to temperature
- Over-the-air charging (<https://digit.in/overaircharging>)
- Full-display pressure-activated fingerprint sensor
- Wristwatch smartphone with a flexible screen
- Holographic projection
- Roll-out QWERTY keypad